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been removed in their usual oxidation states. A reaction in which oxidation number of the element increases is called oxidation and decreases is called reduction.

Redox reactions in which

- two substances combine to form compound(s) are called combination reaction.
- a compound breaks down into two (or) more components is called decomposition reaction
- a compound is replaced by an ion (or atom) of another element are called displacement reactions
- the same compound can undergo both oxidation and reduction and the oxidation state of one and the same element is both increased and decreased called disproportionate reactions.
- competition for electrons occurs between various metals is called competitive electron transfer reaction.

The equation of redox reaction is balanced either by oxidation number method or by ion-electron method.